

PLOT YOUR COURSE

One of the most interesting speaking gigs I've ever had was with an elite group of military servicemembers. When our time was done, I felt like I had learned more from them than they had from me. After a session, I was talking to some of them about military preparation. I asked them how they're able to adapt so quickly when something goes wrong. They said something like, "Actually, things never really go 'wrong,' because we plan for and train for everything. If something happens that derails one plan, we just move on to the next."

For example, they told me about an incident they had on a mission in enemy waters. One of their boats became disabled, so the guys in the second boat immediately jumped into action. They threw all their unnecessary gear into the water to make room for the other men. They went from two boats loaded with men and gear to one boat carrying twice as many people and half as much stuff in a matter of seconds. And, of course, they knew exactly what pieces of gear they could toss overboard without endangering the mission. My day can feel ruined if I have to stop to change a flat tire, but these guys made crucial decisions, consolidated their resources, and got on with the mission in less than a minute without missing a beat. But like they told me, this is something they had trained for. They explained that, when you plan for the obstacles, they don't shake your confidence or interrupt your progress when they happen. I left that speaking engagement with a new attitude about wealth building taken straight out of the Special Forces playbook: *I am going to win—no matter what*. To ensure that victory, though, I must make a plan and stick to it.